The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Fredas, the 23rd of Frostfall (Friday, October 23, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 23 · Price: One Septim



Gandy and Maevy lounge contentedly on the deck under a partly cloudy sky.

Skies o'er the Hold

63° / 46°

Partly Cloudy

Sunrise 6:37 AM · Sunset 5:41 PM

Tomorrow — Partly Cloudy, 58/42

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday · *Tonight* — Waxing Gibbous · *Tomorrow* — Full Moon

waxing toward the full moon

23rd of Frostfall = October 23

Months run one-for-one all year

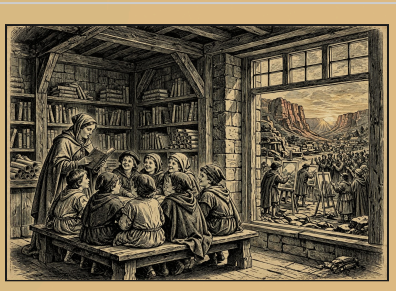
Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Storytime in Payson, Awards Night in the Red Rocks

Payson, Ariz.

Hail, guest of the Hearth, and good Fredas morning — the storm has rolled on, the pines stand washed and shining, and a partly cloudy sky promises a fine fall day over the Rim, high 63 by the Nine. Payson gathers its young readers for Kids Club at Noley's this afternoon, Camp Verde's campers carry on their valley weekend, Show Low paints three friendly ghosts tonight, and Sedona crowns a week of outdoor painting with Awards Night at the Arts Center. Tomorrow brings the Monster Mash, a fall arts fair, and an air fest — take your cloak, traveler, the Hold is merry today.



Storytime at the bookshop hall while painters catch the red rocks outside — a Fredas in the Holds.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — **Noley's Kids Club**, 1:00 to 2:30 p.m. at Noley's, 103 E. State Highway 260, Payson. Michelle Guerrero reads her book The Christmas Witch — a little Christmas in October — and there will be crafts, free books, and a giveaway, thanks to sponsor Time Out, Inc. A sweet, easy afternoon for young guests and their grown-ups, right in the heart of town. Expect a small, friendly bookstore-style gathering, not a big production.

  — **Payson Public Library 2026 Book Sale**, 9:00 a.m. to 4:30 p.m. at Payson Public Library, 328 N. McLane Road, Payson, continuing a sale that runs October 22–24. Tables of donated books, puzzles, and media wait for new homes, priced for browsing rather than bidding, and the Friends of the Library turn the proceeds back into library good works. It is an easy, unhurried stop for guests who like a rummage with a purpose. Come with a tote bag and leave with winter reading — the Rim nights are getting long, by the Nine.

- **Camp Verde**

  — **Camp Carpe Diem Verde Valley 2026**, running October 22–25 at Verde River RV Resort & Cottages, 1472 West Horseshoe Bend Drive, Camp Verde. This hosted RV-and-camping weekend uses Camp Verde as its base for exploring the whole Verde Valley, with hiking, biking, breweries, wineries, and ghost towns by day and campfire gatherings by night. It is a social, ticketed gathering rather than a drop-in town fair, so guests already in the valley with an RV will get the most from it. Expect a ready-made company of fellow travelers and a planned menu of outings.

  — **Adult Game Lab**, 4:00 to 5:30 p.m. at Camp Verde Community Library, 130 Black Bridge Loop Rd., Camp Verde. Grown-ups get the games table today — board and card games in the library's community room, with the library supplying the sets and the company. It is a friendly, low-stakes way to spend a Fredas afternoon with Verde Valley locals. Newcomers are welcome; check the library calendar listing for the day's game before you go.

- **Sedona**

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — Awards Night**, 5:00 to 7:00 p.m. at the Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Road, Sedona, with free admission per the festival guide. After a week of artists painting the red rocks outdoors, the festival gathers for its awards reception, with light refreshments and the week's work fresh off the easel. It is the best night to see the strongest paintings in one room, meet the painters, and hear which canvases the judges chose. Paintings are for sale, so collectors get first pick — arrive at the start, for this is the festival's most social evening.

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — Sunset Vistas Paint-Out**, 3:30 to 6:30 p.m. in Sedona, per Visit Sedona; the listing did not name the exact viewing spot, so check it before you drive over. Festival painters set up in the late light to catch the red rocks at their most golden, working outdoors on the spot while visitors wander and watch. It pairs beautifully with Awards Night straight after — see the paintings made, then see the week's best crowned. A camera earns its keep at this one.

- **Show Low**

  — **Paint & Sip: Three Ghosts**, 6:00 p.m. at Kittle's Fine Art, 100 N. White Mountain Rd., Suite 101, Show Low. A guided evening painting session with a Halloween theme — three ghosts, painted step by step, in a working art studio. It is made for beginners and merry dabblers alike, and you take your canvas home at the end of the night. Register through the studio's Upcoming Classes page at Kittlesfineart.com, per the listing. A fine, cozy way to spend a fall Friday evening in the White Mountains.

- **Prescott**

  — **Trivia with Charly at Whiskey River Tavern**, 5:00 to 7:00 p.m. at Whiskey River Tavern, 214 S. Montezuma St., Prescott. An early-evening trivia bout on Whiskey Row, hosted by Charly, where teams test their wits over tavern fare — think mead-hall riddling with better seating. It is a merry, sociable start to a Prescott evening and friendly to newcomers who join a table. Arrive a little early to claim seats, for trivia crowds settle in fast.

The Days Ahead

- **Sat, Oct. 24**

  — **Payson — Monster Mash**, 4:00 to 9:30 p.m. in Payson. Payson's big family Halloween evening starts earlier this year so families have more room to come and go across the night, with costumes, crowds, and a fall evening in the park. Bring chairs and blankets for the outdoor Halloween movie, The Nightmare Before Christmas, and enjoy the fun as Valley Dwellers trade the lowland heat for Rim Country air. Expect a long, festive evening rather than a quick trick-or-treat stop. Check Adventure Payson for the venue details before you go.

  — **Sedona — Fall Arts & Crafts Show**, 9:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. at the Sedona Heritage Museum, 735 Jordan Road, Sedona. The museum's annual fall fair is timed for early holiday shopping, with handmade jewelry, ceramics, fine art, home décor, cards, woodcarvings, glass, candles, and lotions from local and regional makers. Many of these artisans do only this show or a handful of others, so the goods are genuinely hard to find elsewhere. The museum grounds in Jordan Historical Park make it a pleasant browse, not a mall run.

— **Prescott — Prescott Regional Airport AirFest**, starting 11:00 a.m. at Prescott Regional Airport, Prescott, and free per the City page. The airport's second annual AirFest is a family-friendly celebration of aviation, with aircraft and military displays, food trucks, and a Prescott Fire Department Touch-a-Truck so kids can climb on real fire equipment. It is an open-air, wander-at-your-own-pace day rather than a seated airshow. A good all-ages outing and an easy drive for guests already headed to Prescott.

- **Mon, Oct. 26**

  — **Pine-Strawberry — Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose**, 4:00 p.m. at 3270 N. Highway 87, Pine; no end time was stated in the listing. Local players take turns rather than one headline act, and open mics in the twin villages are community living rooms — expect neighbors, a few surprises, and music made for love of it. It is good for guests who want an evening that feels like the town, not a show put on for tourists. Check the Facebook event before going for sign-up and venue details.

- **Sun, Oct. 25**

  — **Prescott — Prescott Community Gardens Fall Festival**, 10:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. at the Prescott Community Gardens, per the Prescott events calendar; the listing did not print the street address, so check it before you go. The gardeners open the gates for a fall celebration among the beds — a harvest-season gathering with the year's growing behind it and winter planting ahead. Expect neighbors, garden talk, and a last wander through green things before the frosts settle in. A gentle Sundas outing for guests who garden, or wish they did.

- **Thu, Oct. 29**

  — **Pine-Strawberry — Haunted Barn at the Pine Community Center**, 5:00 to 10:00 p.m. at the Pine Community Center grounds, 3886 AZ-87, Pine. The twin villages raise their haunted barn for Halloween week — a walk-through fright made by locals, in a real barn, under the Rim. It is the Holdings' own harvest-of-scares, merry and spooky in equal measure, and a fine excuse for an evening drive up the 87. Check the event page for tickets and age guidance before you go, and mind the mountain road home.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The shield, the torches, and the doors — the Hearth's workshop quests await.

- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Overdue — was due Oct. 17. Finalize the size, cut and engrave the layered plywood, mount the 3D-printed troll relief, and finish with spar urethane.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Due Oct. 24. Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, placed for best sight from the walkway.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue — was due Oct. 10. Paint, seal for sun, wire the sockets with the breaker off, mount both torches, and test at dusk.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Oct. 3. Print two torches plus the socket test piece and test-fit the bulb and socket.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Sept. 26. Measure the bulb and socket, scale the sconce model, check the door-light wiring, and slice in PETG.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Due Oct. 24. The front and side door work for the guest house.

Due Saturday, Oct. 24: mount the shield by the front door, and the doors quest comes due the same day — the workshop will be busy, by the Nine!

Merchant of the Hold

Thanks A Latte · *Camp Verde*



Thanks A Latte in Camp Verde — house-roasted beans and the famed Verde Latte.

In a converted old gas station on Camp Verde's Main Street, Thanks A Latte roasts its own beans right on site and pours the Verde Latte, the cup the whole valley talks about. By the Nine, no espresso engine could exist in Skyrim without a little magic, so picture a neat steam-and-pressure enchantment hissing behind the counter while breakfast tacos, pistachio muffins, and a mighty BLAT sandwich come out fast and fresh. The signature thing to try is the Verde Latte — and ask them to butter-fry your muffin while you are at it.

> *"the Verde Latte was THE BEST latte I have ever had."* — TripAdvisor review

348 S. Main St., Camp Verde, AZ 86322. Hours: Wed.–Fri. 6:00 a.m.–2:30 p.m., Sat.–Sun. 8:00 a.m.–2:30 p.m., closed Mondays and Tuesdays. Phone: (928) 567-6450. Price range: inexpensive ($). Good to know: beans are roasted on site, you order up front and they bring food to your table by number flag, and there is free off-street parking and patio seating. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: Because it is the Verde Valley's own roastery-meets-mead-hall morning stop — house-roasted coffee, the famed Verde Latte, and a warm small-town welcome before a day at Montezuma Castle or Fort Verde. Great praise is great, and this little coffee hall has earned every word!

Stories Around the Rim

He Was HERE Ten Minutes Ago



The Jarl's hall, ten minutes too late — the bench still warm, the Dragonborn gone.

A mead trader down the south road swears the hooded one reached the great walled town at last — and the Hold, as ever, missed him by ten minutes. He stood in the Jarl's own hall, the trader says, carrying word of the dragon at the watchtower, and the hall went quiet as snowfall.

What happened next, no two tongues agree on. One guard swears the Jarl offered him a steward's post on the spot; another swears he asked only for work and a warm corner. All agree on this: when the steward came back with the parchment to sign, the bench was empty, the goblet still warm, and the door swinging.

Mabel doesn't believe a word of it. Earl, who was nowhere near, is offended anyway — on principle.

Tales from the Treeline

Gus's Pie-Delivery Service



Gus's Pie-Delivery Service — five pies delivered, one under investigation.

Gus (an orc baker) woke with a grand notion: the whole forest should have pie before breakfast, and he would deliver it himself — except his enormous hands were needed at the oven. So he promoted Earl (an elk) to delivery cart, balanced a tray of six tiny pies across Earl's antlers, and sent him down the path at a dignified walk.

Henny (the Hearth's chicken) rode on Earl's back as inspector, pecking nothing, judging everything. Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) took the airmail route with one pie in a cloth sling, zigzagging as his kinked tail demands, and set it down — gently, miraculously — right in the middle of Mabel's (a wood elf's) herb garden, on the one flat stone.

Earl delivered five pies without a crumb lost, which Mabel called the most respectable thing to happen all Frostfall. The sixth pie is still unaccounted for. Henny has crumbs on her beak and no comment.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Fredas be free of dragons, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com